

Email: lalthoff@stanford.edu

Web: www.lukasalthoff.com

EMPLOYMENT

Stanford University

Assistant Professor, Department of Economics

Since 2025

Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (SIEPR)

2023 – 2024

EDUCATION

Princeton University

Ph.D. in Economics

2018 – 2023

London School of Economics

M.Sc. in Econometrics and Mathematical Economics

2017 – 2018

University of Munich

B.Sc. in Economics

2014 – 2017

Technical University of Munich

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Finance

2013 – 2017

AFFILIATIONS

National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER), Faculty Research Fellow

Since 2026

Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research, Faculty Fellow

Since 2025

Stanford Center on Poverty and Inequality, Faculty Affiliate

Since 2025

Stanford Center for Comparative Studies in Race & Ethnicity, Faculty Affiliate

Since 2025

CESifo, Affiliate Member

Since 2024

US Census Bureau, Special Sworn Status Researcher

Since 2023

Institute of Labor Economics (IZA), Research Affiliate

Since 2023

VISITING POSITIONS

NYU Stern School of Business

2024 – 2025

Center for Economic Studies (CES), University of Munich

2024

Opportunity & Inclusive Growth Institute (OIGI), Minneapolis Fed

2023

PUBLICATIONS

“Jim Crow and Black Economic Progress After Slavery”

2024

with Hugo Reichardt

[Quarterly Journal of Economics](#)

“The Geography of Remote Work”

2022

with Fabian Eckert, Sharat Ganapati, Conor Walsh

[Regional Science and Urban Economics](#)

WORKING PAPERS

- “Task-Specific Technical Change and Comparative Advantage”** 2026
with Hugo Reichardt
- “The GI Bill and Racial Inequality”** 2026
with Christiane Szerman
- “Mothers, Schools, and the Making of American Human Capital Mobility”** 2025
with Harriet Brookes Gray, Hugo Reichardt
[Review of Economic Studies, Accepted](#)
- “Two Steps Forward, One Step Back: Racial Income Gaps among Women since 1950”** 2023

WORK IN PROGRESS

- “Discrimination and Economic Development”**
with Omer Ali

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Seminar presentations

- 2026 (*incl. scheduled*): Federal Reserve Board, Kiel Institute for the World Economy, Temple University Japan, UC Santa Barbara, University of Houston, University of Pittsburgh, University of Southern California, World Economic Forum
- 2025: German Ministry of Finance, Harvard, Northwestern, Rockwool Foundation, UNSW Sydney
- 2024: Brookings, Chicago Fed, German Ministry of Finance, NYU, Stanford, UC Davis, UCLA Anderson, UC Merced
- 2023: Berkeley, Harvard, LSE, Minneapolis Fed, Stanford, Stanford GSB, Stellenbosch (LEAP), Tilburg, UChicago Booth, UChicago Harris, University of British Columbia, University of Munich, Yale SOM
- 2022: Applied Young Economist Webinar, City University of New York, Florida State, Institute for the World Economy, Princeton
- 2021: Princeton, Princeton History, YSI-EHES Economic History Graduate Webinar

Conference presentations

- 2026 (*incl. scheduled*): NBER Summer Institute, Frontiers in AI and the Economy Conference (Chicago Fed), NBER Race and Stratification, CEPR Applied Micro & Economic History Workshop, World Economic Forum on the Future of Manufacturing (San Francisco), Workshop on AI and the Economics of Recursive Self-Improvement (Constellation Institute), West Coast Spatial Workshop (Stanford GSB)
- 2025: NBER Summer Institute, Australian Political Economy Workshop, German Economists Abroad Conference, Stanford Provostial Fellows Symposium
- 2024: NBER Summer Institute, Opportunity Insights Conference, “Institutions, Organizations, and Growth” (UChicago BFI), “Barriers to Economic Opportunity and Inclusion” (UChicago & Cleveland Fed), SED Annual Meeting
- 2023: NBER Summer Institute, Foundations of Long-Run Prosperity Conference (Hoover Institution), Chicago Economic History Workshop, UC Davis Economic History Workshop, Economic History Rookiefest (Northwestern), Southern Economic Association Conference

2022: NBER Economics of Mobility, NBER Summer Institute, CESifo Venice Summer Institute, Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (Philadelphia Fed), European & North American Meetings of the Urban Economics Association, Lindau Nobel Laureate Meeting, Economic History Association, Inequality Conference (UKonstanz), Rising Scholars Conference (UChicago Booth), Workshop on “Causal Inference with Spatial Data” (RWI), Development and Political Economics Graduate Student Conference (Berkeley & Stanford), Yale Economic History Graduate Student Conference, Economic and Business History Society, CIREQ PhD Students’ Conference, Warwick Economics PhD Conference, Workshop on “Racial and Ethnic Disparities in the Labor Market” (Berkeley & Princeton), Workshop on “Racial Disparities in the 1944 G.I. Bill” (Brandeis)

Referee service

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics
 American Economic Journal: Economic Policy
 American Economic Review
 American Economic Review: Insights
 Economica
 European Research Council
 Explorations in Economic History
 Journal of Economic History
 Journal of Economic Literature
 Journal of Labor Economics
 Journal of Law and Economics
 Journal of Political Economy
 Journal of Regional Science
 Journal of the European Economic Association
 Journal of Urban Economics
 National Science Foundation
 Regional Science and Urban Economics
 Regional Studies
 Review of Economic Studies
 Review of Economics and Statistics
 Quarterly Journal of Economics

Award Committees

John Locke Institute Global Essay Prize
 US Fiscal Challenge

AWARDS, GRANTS, AND FELLOWSHIPS

Awards

W.E. Upjohn Institute Dissertation Award	2023
Erik Olin Wright Prize, Havens Wright Center for Social Justice	2023
Princeton University Graduate Student Teaching Award	2022
Urban Economics Association Best Student Paper Award	2022
IPUMS USA Best Student Research Award	2022

Grants

Anthropic Economic Futures Grant (\$50,000)	2025
Stanford Impact Labs (\$50,000)	2025
Russell Sage Foundation (\$66,000)	2024
Stanford Institute for Economic Policy Research (\$10,000)	2023
Princeton Program for Research on Inequality (\$10,000)	2021

Fellowships

Stanford Impact Labs Design Fellowship	2025 – 2026
Prize Fellowship in the Social Sciences, Princeton University	2022 – 2023
Doctoral Fellowship, Princeton University	2018 – 2023
German National Scholarship Foundation Fellowship	2017 – 2018
German Academic Exchange Service Fellowship	2017 – 2018
Dr Jost Henkel Foundation Fellowship	2017 – 2018
Deloitte Foundation Fellowship	2015 – 2017
Hans Rudolf Foundation Fellowship	2015 – 2016
Hanns Seidel Foundation Fellowship	2013 – 2017
Claussen Simon Foundation Fellowship	2012 – 2013

TEACHING

Graduate

Topics in US and International Economic History (Stanford ECON 226) Since 2025

This graduate course emphasizes theoretical and empirical methods for studying long-run economic change, with a focus on the forces that drive progress and the barriers that prevent it from being broadly shared. Drawing on historical evidence and economic analysis, we investigate how societies have generated — and distributed — economic opportunity, and what lessons the past provides for the future. While the evidence will span various periods of American history, the course will not cover those periods chronologically but rather focus on critical analysis of specific questions and mechanisms of change.

Undergraduate

Progress and Inequality (Stanford ECON 30) Starting 2026

Progress is humanity's defining achievement: the cumulative process of each generation building on the knowledge of the last. It came slowly at first — millennia from foraging to settled agriculture, centuries from agriculture to industry — then astonishingly fast. But progress has not been shared equally. Every great leap forward created winners and losers. In this course, we explore what drives progress, what determines who gets to benefit from it, and what we can do to promote broadly shared progress. We trace the tension between progress and inequality from forager societies to Artificial Intelligence, using tools from economic history, applied microeconomics, and data analysis. Students read frontier research and popular writing. They will work with historical and contemporary datasets. The centerpiece is a storytelling project: using AI tools, you will build an interactive visual essay that brings one aspect of progress to life for a broad audience. You pick the topic. Make it worth reading.

Guest lectures

2026 (*incl. scheduled*): UCLA

2025: Stanford (Political Science), UC Irvine, Spelman College

2024: NYU Stern, Stanford

2023: Princeton